📊 SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 29

Reports in Salesforce

Complete Guide — Report Types, 4 Report Formats, Filters, Groupings & Hands-on Demos

- 📊 What is a Salesforce Report?
- 🧩 Standard vs. Custom Report Types
- 📐 4 Formats (Tabular, Summary, Matrix, Joined)
- 🔍 Filter Logic & Cross Filters
- 🪣 Bucket Fields & Summaries
- 🧪 Closed Won & Cross Filter Demos

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL
29 of Series	~28 Minutes	Beginner to Intermediate

CORE DOMAIN

Analytics & Intelligence

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SECTION 1

Introduction & Course Context

⏱ 0:00 – 0:50

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** Every company stores massive amounts of data in Salesforce: thousands of Leads, Accounts, Contacts, Opportunities, Cases, and custom records.

However, simply storing data in a database is meaningless unless business leaders can extract answers:

- *"How much revenue did our sales team generate this quarter?"*
- *"Which sales rep is closing the most high-value deals?"*
- *"Which marketing lead sources yield the highest win rate?"*
- *"How many customer support cases remain unresolved past our 24-hour SLA?"*

This is where **Salesforce Reports** come in — transforming millions of raw database rows into actionable business intelligence!

SECTION 2

What is a Report & Why Do We Need Them?

⏱ 0:50 – 3:30

📌 OFFICIAL DEFINITION

A Report in Salesforce is a curated list of records that meet specific criteria. It allows admins to organize, filter, group, summarize, and visualize data into tables and charts to answer critical operational and executive business questions.

📈 THE EVOLUTION OF DATA TO INSIGHTS

1. Raw Data: 1,000 Opportunity records in a database table.
2. Filtered Information: Showing only the 150 Opportunities marked *Closed Won* this fiscal year.
3. Grouped & Summarized Intelligence: Grouping by *Opportunity Owner* and calculating *Sum of Amount* reveals that Priya generated ₹40L while Rahul generated ₹25L!

SECTION 3

Report Types: Standard vs. Custom

⏱ 3:30 – 7:00

📌 WHAT IS A REPORT TYPE?

A **Report Type** is the foundational blueprint that determines **which objects, relationships, and fields** are available to build your report. You cannot add fields to a report if they do not exist in the selected Report Type!

Criterion	📦 Standard Report Types	🛠️ Custom Report Types (CRT)
Creation	Created automatically by Salesforce out-of-the-box	Created manually by Admins in Setup
Examples	`Accounts, Opportunities with Products, Cases`	`Accounts with or without Contacts and Activities`
Relationship Logic	Predefined parent-child joins (typically "with" only)	Configurable "with" (inner join) or "with or without" (outer join)
When to Use	Covers 80%+ of everyday operational reports	When complex multi-object relationships or custom fields are needed

SECTION 4 — CORE ARCHITECTURE

The 4 Report Formats in Salesforce

⏱ 7:00 – 11:00

FORMAT 1

1. Tabular Report

Simple list of rows and columns (just like an Excel spreadsheet). No groupings. Ideal for generating mailing lists, backup exports, or simple lists of records.

FORMAT 2 — MOST POPULAR

2. Summary Report

Records are grouped by one or more **Rows** (e.g., grouped by *Opportunity Owner*). Supports subtotals, record counts, and acts as the #1 source for Dashboard charts.

FORMAT 3

3. Matrix Report

Records are grouped by both **Rows AND Columns** (cross-tabulation). E.g., Rows grouped by *Owner* and Columns grouped by *Stage*.

FORMAT 4

4. Joined Report

Combines up to **5 distinct report blocks** into a single view. Each block can have its own filters, columns, and groupings sharing a common master object.

SECTION 5

Filters, Filter Logic & Cross Filters

⏱ 11:00 – 14:00

- **Standard Filters:** Built-in scopes like *Show Me* (All Opportunities vs. My Opportunities) and *Date Field* (Close Date = Current FY).
- **Field Filters:** Filtering records by specific field values (e.g., `Stage EQUALS Closed Won`).
- **Filter Logic:** Combines multiple filters using Boolean expressions. Instead of forcing all conditions to match, you can write: `1 AND (2 OR 3)`.

🔗 WHAT IS A CROSS FILTER?

A **Cross Filter** filters parent records based on the existence (or non-existence) of related child records:

- `Accounts WITH Opportunities` ➔ Only accounts with at least one deal.
- `Accounts WITHOUT Opportunities` ➔ Neglected accounts that need sales outreach!

SECTION 6

Summarizing Data & Bucket Fields

⏱ 14:00 – 18:00

1. Summarizing Numerical Fields

You can aggregate any currency or number field using 4 mathematical functions: **Sum**, **Average**, **Min**, or **Max**.

2. Bucket Fields (Categorize Without Admin Fields)

WHY CREATE A BUCKET FIELD?

Suppose executive leadership wants to categorize deal sizes into *Small*, *Medium*, and *Enterprise*. Rather than asking a developer to build a new custom picklist on the Opportunity object, admins can create a **Bucket Field** directly inside the Report Builder:

- **Small Deal:** ₹0 – ₹50,000
- **Medium Deal:** ₹50,001 – ₹2,00,000
- **Enterprise Deal:** > ₹2,00,000

SECTION 7

Report Charts, Folders & Exporting Data

⏱ 19:15 – 22:00

- **Report Charts:** Any Summary or Matrix report can display an inline visual chart (*Bar*, *Column*, *Donut*, *Funnel*, *Scatter*).
- **Report Folders:** Reports are organized into folders (*Sales*, *Executive*, *Support*) with granular permissions: *View*, *Edit*, or *Manage*.
- **Exporting Reports:** Users with export permissions can export report data as **Formatted Report** (retaining colors and headers) or **Details Only** (clean CSV / Excel for pivot tables).

SECTIONS 8 & 9 — HANDS-ON PRACTICE

💻 Practical Demos: Summary Report & Cross Filter

⏱ 22:00 – 28:00

Demo 1: Closed Won Opportunities by Owner (Summary Report)

1. Navigate to **App Launcher ➔ Reports** and click **New Report**.
2. Choose Report Type: `Opportunities` → click **Start Report**.
3. Under **Filters:** Set `Show Me: All Opportunities`, `Close Date: Current Year`, `Stage: Closed Won`.
4. Add columns: *Opportunity Name*, *Account Name*, *Amount*, *Close Date*.
5. Under **Group Rows:** Add `Opportunity Owner`.
6. Click the dropdown on the **Amount** column → select `Summarize ➔ Sum`.
7. Click **Add Chart** → select *Column Chart* showing Total Amount by Owner.
8. Click **Save & Run** → Save as `Closed Won Deals Current Year` in the *Sales Reports* folder! 🎉

Demo 2: Accounts Without Opportunities (Cross Filter)

1. Create a new report using Report Type: `Accounts`.
2. Open the **Filters** tab in the builder.
3. Click the filter dropdown arrow (▼) and select **Add Cross Filter**.
4. Configure the cross filter statement: `Accounts WITHOUT Opportunities`.
5. Click **Apply** and **Run**. Salesforce immediately presents all neglected Accounts that have zero sales pipeline!

SECTION 10 — MINDSET

The 5 Questions to Ask Before Building Any Report

⏱ Best Practice Framework

1	2	3	4	5
Data Object?	**Report Type?**	**Filters?**	**Grouping?**	**Summary?**
Accounts, Leads, or Cases?	Standard vs. Custom?	Which records qualify?	By Owner, Stage, or Month?	Count, Sum, or Average?

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 29

01

A **Report** filters, groups, and summarizes records to convert raw database entries into actionable business intelligence.

02

Report Types act as the foundational blueprint determining which objects and fields are available for analysis.

03

4 Core Formats: **Tabular** (simple list), **Summary** (row grouping), **Matrix** (row + column), and **Joined** (up to 5 blocks).

04

Cross Filters filter parent records by testing whether related child records exist (e.g., *Accounts WITHOUT Opportunities*).

05

Bucket Fields allow quick categorization of numerical/text values without creating custom fields in Object Manager.

06

The Golden Formula: **Report Type + Filters + Grouping + Summaries = Strategic Business Insights**!

COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 30

Dashboards in Salesforce

Learn how to take your report data and assemble dynamic executive dashboards for business stakeholders!

These notes are an official companion to the YouTube video. Practice hands-on in your Salesforce Developer Org!